

PURNIMA: UK SUPPORT TO POST-EARTHQUAKE RECOVERY IN NEPAL

Purnima is a five-year programme (2017-2022) funded by the UK Department for International Development (DFID) and managed by Mott MacDonald. The objective is long-term positive change in the lives of people in earthquake-affected regions of Nepal.

The programme will work mainly in four of the worst-affected districts (Gorkha, Dhading, Nuwakot, and Rasuwa) through five Output Areas:

1. Inclusive planning at local level through technical assistance to government agencies.
2. Reconstruction of rural infrastructure, including water supply, foot trails, footbridges, and schools.
3. Stimulation of economic growth, job creation through private sector development in relation to construction, including access to finance, innovation, and skills.
4. Funding interventions for inclusion of vulnerable groups to ensure that no one is left behind in the recovery effort.
5. Monitoring, evaluation and learning.



Our vision for the programme is not just to reconstruct earthquake-damaged infrastructure. We believe that the situation in post-earthquake Nepal provides an opportunity to build back better and to improve infrastructure, social inclusivity and economic opportunities. Our objective is to ensure that no one is left behind in the reconstruction process, and we will target the most vulnerable population in all activities. Infrastructure will be selected through a participatory planning process, by working closely with communities and local governments.



The project aims to strengthen the ability of local government to deliver inclusive services and infrastructure at a local level. We will link our interventions in a systematic and coherent way to rebuild rural infrastructure and increase the socio-economic wellbeing and resilience of the most vulnerable groups. The specific vulnerable groups that we will target under the 'leave no one behind' component include persons with disabilities, the elderly, vulnerable single women, Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs) after resettlement, and extremely poor, food-insecure people from remote areas.

We will ensure that our activities are consistent with local needs and priorities and will coordinate with other government programmes, civil society, NGOs, private sector, and other stakeholders and development partners so that we work together towards a common vision. By continuing until 2022, seven years after the earthquakes, the programme will provide the long-term support for recovery which has been shown from international experience to be so important.

We have established partnerships with UNWFP, OXFAM, CARE, Confederation of Nepalese Industries (CNI) and GEOCE to carry out activities. We will manage the Challenge Fund to ensure we 'leave no one behind' by awarding grants to district, national or international NGOs, selected through competitive calls for proposals.